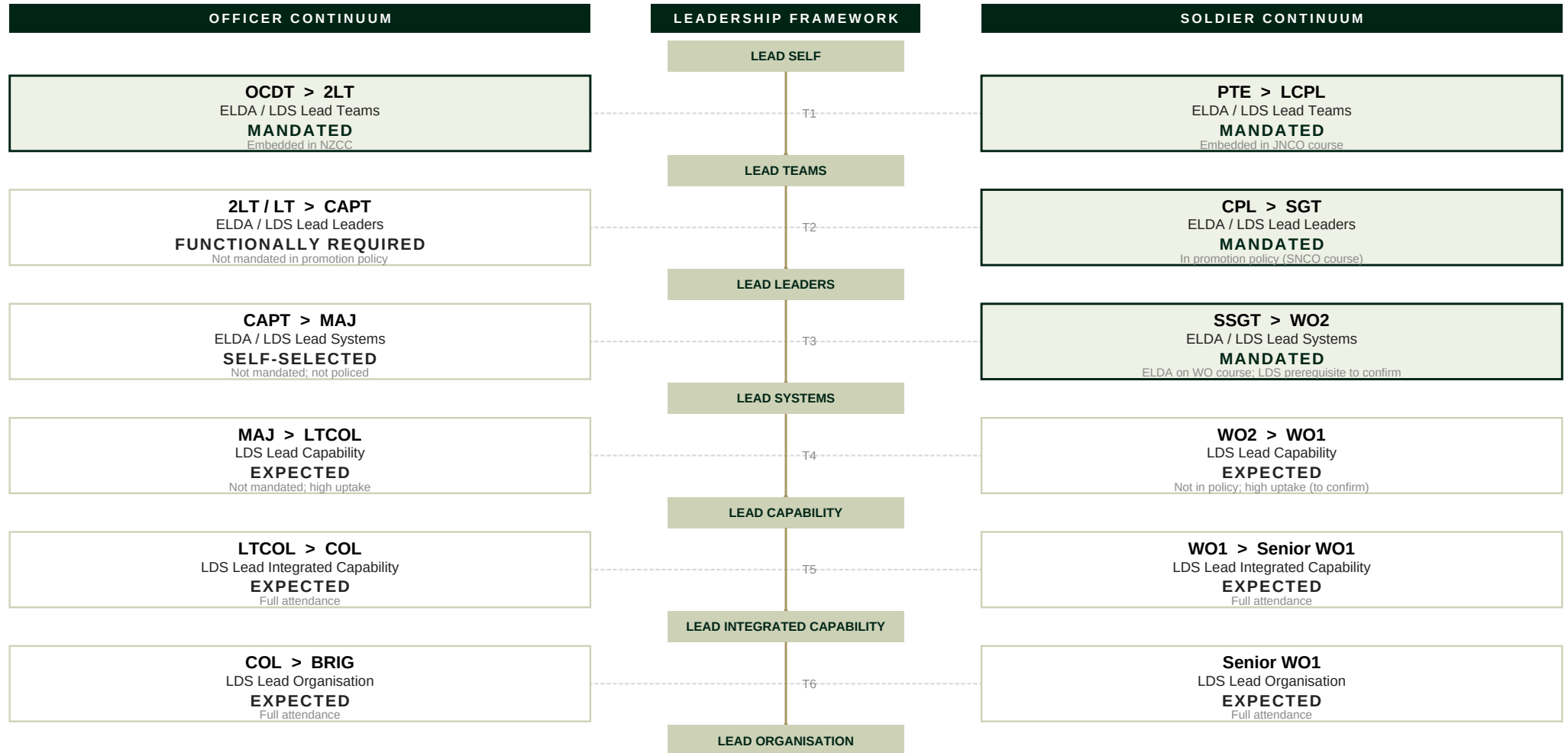


Two continuums. One leadership framework.

HOW DELIBERATELY DOES ARMY LINK LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT TO PROGRESSION THROUGH ITS OFFICER AND SOLDIER PROMOTION CONTINUUMS?

New Zealand Army Leadership Centre | Army Command School

Date: September 2026 · Status: **Draft for AITC discussion**



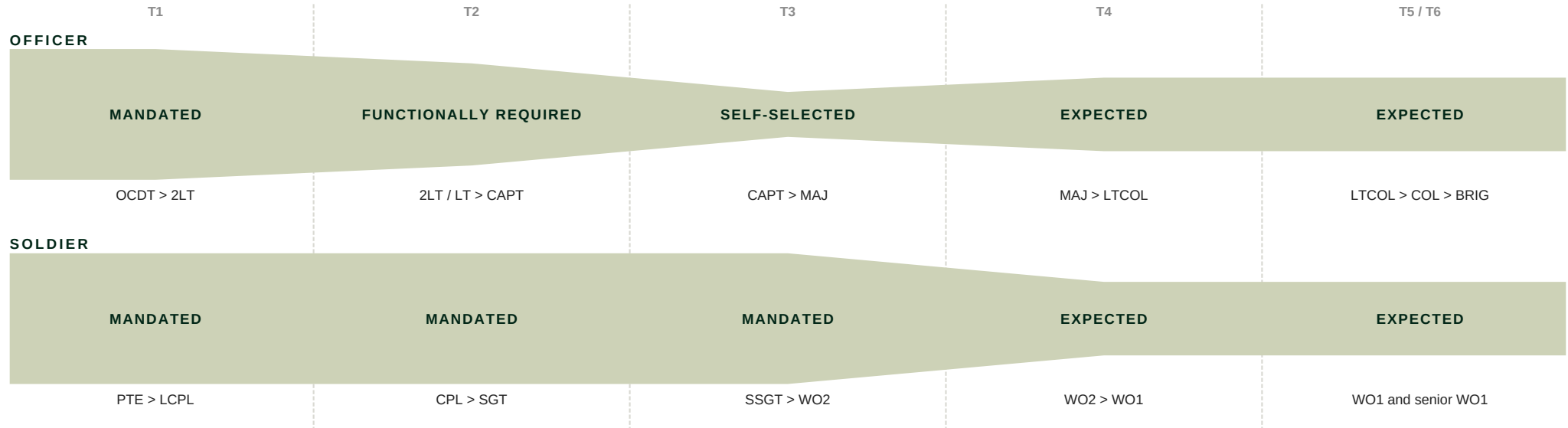
SAME LEADERSHIP FRAMEWORK. DIFFERENT MECHANISMS FOR ENSURING DEVELOPMENT OCCURS.

Shaded: mandated in policy or embedded in the qualifying course. Rank pairings follow the NZALC review of 9 September 2026 and place the comparison; they do not assert that a rank equals a level.

Where is development deliberately linked to progression?

THE TWO CONTINUUMS AT THE SAME TRANSITIONS, THEN THE QUESTION FOR ARMY

New Zealand Army Leadership Centre | Army Command School

Date: September 2026 · Status: **Draft for AITC discussion**

Band thickness is the strength of the link between the development and the career transition: mandated, functionally required, expected, self-selected.

The issue may not be an absence of leadership development. It is the absence of a consistently deliberate mechanism linking the right development to the right career transition.

SOLDIERS

Leadership development is deliberately embedded in key promotion pathways.

OFFICERS

Equivalent development exists, but its linkage to career progression varies considerably across the continuum.

THE QUESTION

Is that difference deliberate, and if so, what is the rationale?

IS THIS A CONSCIOUS CHOICE?

IF YES

What is the rationale for treating Officer and Soldier leadership development differently?

IF NO

Should Army establish a more consistent mechanism for ensuring development occurs before increased leadership responsibility?

No recommendation. The organisation answers.